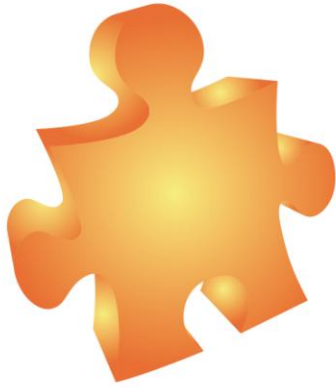




S.H.A.P.E.

Your fit in God's great design!

Spiritual Gifts

Heart (Passions)

Abilities

Personal Behavior

Experiences

"SHAPED by God for the Service of Christ"

NAME: _____

Church of the Palms PCUSA
3224 Bee Ridge Road, Sarasota, FL
(941) 924 – 1323, info@churchofthepalms.org
www.churchofthepalms.org



Church of the Palms

Mission of Church of the Palms:

“Equipping Disciples for the Service of Christ”

Purpose of identifying your S.H.A.P.E.:

We are all created by God as unique individuals, with different gifts, passions and values, abilities, behavior patterns, experiences, and interests. We are so complex that we need some time and a thoughtful process to truly discover ourselves. This personal assessment can provide us with insights into how we have been prepared for discipleship to do the Lord’s work on earth.

Except for the last two pages, these work sheets are for your eyes only. If you choose to turn in the summary pages (and we hope you will!) it is truly your decision. We hope that you will discover something new about yourself, or confirm some things you already know about yourself, that will show you a way to become more active in missional living. We also hope that you will choose to engage more actively in the faith community at Church of the Palms (COP).

If, however, you discover that you are called to a ministry outside COP, then this process will have served both you and the Lord well.

Be open and honest, and pray for divine guidance as you complete these survey items, and you will be blessed with what you discover about yourself and how you can use your unique gifts in a more rewarding and satisfying way.

In Christ,

A handwritten signature in blue ink, reading "J. D. McLeavel". The signature is written in a cursive style with a large initial "J" and "D".



You have chosen to experience "S.H.A.P.E.", a unique seminar designed to help you discover how God has shaped you to serve Him. God is actively working in your life, and He wants you to understand and put into practice the full potential of who He has uniquely created you to be in His kingdom, for His purposes, and for His glory.

God Uniquely Designed You For A Specific Purpose In His Kingdom.

"For I know the plans I have for you, declares the Lord, plans to prosper you and not to harm you, plans to give you hope and a future." Jeremiah 29:11 (NIV)

According To Scripture, Whatever Your Profession, Your Primary Role In Life Is: Serving Jesus Christ.

1. You have been **created** to serve Christ.

"For we are God's workmanship, created in Christ Jesus to do good works, which God prepared in advance for us to do." Ephesians 2:10 (NIV)

2. You have been **saved** for Christ's work.

"It is He who saved us and chose us for His holy work, not because we deserved it, but because that was His plan long before the world began..." 2 Timothy 1:9 (LB)

3. You have been **gifted** for Christ's service.

"As each one has received a special gift, employ it in serving one another as good stewards of the manifold grace of God." 1 Peter 4:10 (NAS)

4. You have been **challenged** to serve Christ.

"Your attitude should be the same as that of Christ Jesus... (who) made Himself nothing, taking the very nature of a servant..." Philippians 2:5-7 (NIV)

5. You will be **rewarded** for serving Christ.

"Whatever you do, work at it with all your heart, as working for the Lord, not for men, since you know that you will receive an inheritance from the Lord as a reward." Colossians 3:23-24 (NIV)



SPIRITUAL GIFTS

Heart

Abilities

Personal Behavior

Experiences

WHAT THE BIBLE SAYS ABOUT SPIRITUAL GIFTS

Romans 12:1-8, I Corinthians 12-14, Ephesians 4:11-16, I Peter 4:7-11

“Now, about spiritual gifts, I do not want you to be ignorant.”

– 1 Corinthians 12:1 (NIV)

1. What is a spiritual gift?

A spiritual gift is a special ability given by the Holy Spirit to every believer at conversion so that he/she can serve others with ease, enjoyment, and effectiveness.

“Each of you should use whatever gifts you have received to serve others, faithfully administering God’s grace in it various forms.” – 1 Peter 4:10

2. Who receives spiritual gifts?

Each and every believer receives at least one spiritual gift. *“But **each of you** has your own gift from God; one has this gift, another has that.”* – 1 Corinthians 7:7 (TNIV)

3. Why does God give spiritual gifts?

God gives believers spiritual gifts so that they may better serve others.

*“Each of you should use whatever gift you have received **to serve others...**”*
-- 1 Peter 4:10 (TNIV)

4. What does God expect me to do with my spiritual gift?

God wants me to recognize, energize and utilize my spiritual gift.

“Do not neglect your gift... Fan into flame the gift of God...Each of you should use whatever gift you have received...” 1 Timothy 4:14; 2 Timothy 1:6; 1 Peter 4:10 (TNIV)

Spiritual Gifts Survey

Directions

This is not a test, so there are no wrong answers.

Select one response you feel best characterizes you and place that number in the blank provided.

Do not spend too much time on any one item. Usually your immediate response is best.

Please give an answer for each item. Do not skip any items. Your choices are:

- 5 – Highly characteristic of me/definitely true for me
- 4 – Most of the time this would describe me/be true for me
- 3 – Frequently characteristic of me/true for me about 50% of the time
- 2 – Occasionally characteristic of me/true for me about 25% of the time
- 1 – Not at all characteristic of me/definitely untrue for me

- _____ 1. I have the ability to make critical decisions when necessary.
- _____ 2. I have the ability to organize ideas, resources, time, and people effectively.
- _____ 3. I am willing to study and prepare for the task of teaching.
- _____ 4. I enjoy studying and learning lots of new facts.
- _____ 5. I am able to relate the truths of God to specific situations.
- _____ 6. I have given to others God's messages of warning and judgment.
- _____ 7. I am able to sense the true motivation of persons and movements.
- _____ 8. I have a natural tendency to encourage others.
- _____ 9. I have a God-given ability to help others grow in their faith.
- _____ 10. I have a special ability to trust God in difficult situations.
- _____ 11. I possess a special ability to communicate the truth of salvation.
- _____ 12. I have a strong desire to contribute to the establishment of new ministries.
- _____ 13. I take action to meet physical and practical needs.
- _____ 14. I am sensitive to the hurts of people.
- _____ 15. I experience joy in meeting needs through sharing possessions.
- _____ 16. I enjoy entertaining guests in my home.
- _____ 17. I can adapt my guidance to fit the maturity of those working with me.
- _____ 18. I can delegate and assign meaningful work.
- _____ 19. I have an ability and desire to teach others.
- _____ 20. I like to spend time digging into facts.

Spiritual Gifts Survey

5 – Highly characteristic of me/definitely true for me
4 – Most of the time this would describe me/be true for me
3 – Frequently characteristic of me/true for me about 50% of the time
2 – Occasionally characteristic of me/true for me about 25% of the time
1 – Not at all characteristic of me/definitely untrue for me

- _____ 21. I am usually able to analyze a situation correctly.
- _____ 22. I often feel that I have a message from God to deliver to others.
- _____ 23. I can recognize when a person is genuine/honest.
- _____ 24. I can identify those who need encouragement.
- _____ 25. I am willing to take the initiative in helping other Christians grow in their faith.
- _____ 26. I am willing to yield to God's will rather than question and waver.
- _____ 27. I am willing to do whatever it takes to see others come to Christ.
- _____ 28. I would like to be more active in getting the gospel to people in other lands.
- _____ 29. It makes me happy to do things for people in need.
- _____ 30. I have an acute awareness of the emotions of other people, such as loneliness, pain, fear, and anger.
- _____ 31. I am a cheerful giver.
- _____ 32. I am able to make strangers feel at ease.
- _____ 33. I am able to communicate vision in such a way that others commit to making the vision a reality.
- _____ 34. I am successful in getting a group to do its work efficiently.
- _____ 35. I have the ability to use multiple teaching styles.
- _____ 36. I am able to discover new truths about many things.
- _____ 37. I often am consulted when fellow Christians are struggling to make difficult decisions.
- _____ 38. I have spiritual insights from Scripture concerning issues and people that compel me to speak out.
- _____ 39. I can sense when a person is acting in accord with God's will.
- _____ 40. I often think about how I can comfort and encourage others.

Spiritual Gifts Survey

- 5 – Highly characteristic of me/definitely true for me
4 – Most of the time this would describe me/be true for me
3 – Frequently characteristic of me/true for me about 50% of the time
2 – Occasionally characteristic of me/true for me about 25% of the time
1 – Not at all characteristic of me/definitely untrue for me

- _____ 41. I have trained Christians to be more obedient disciples of Christ.
- _____ 42. I can trust in God even when things look dark.
- _____ 43. I am able to present the gospel to lost persons in such a way that they accept the Lord and His salvation.
- _____ 44. I have a strong desire to take the gospel to places where it has never been heard.
- _____ 45. I am sensitive to the needs of people.
- _____ 46. I am attracted to people who are hurting.
- _____ 47. I am a generous giver.
- _____ 48. I enjoy reaching out to new people in my church and community.
- _____ 49. I can determine where God wants a group to go and help it get there.
- _____ 50. I have been able to make effective and efficient plans for accomplishing the goals of a group.
- _____ 51. I explain Scripture in such a way that others understand it.
- _____ 52. I can organize facts into meaningful presentations.
- _____ 53. I can usually see spiritual solutions to problems.
- _____ 54. I have delivered to other people; messages that have come directly from God.
- _____ 55. I can sense when a person is acting under God's leadership.
- _____ 56. I welcome opportunities to help people who need comfort, consolation, encouragement and counseling.
- _____ 57. I am able to give spiritual direction to others.
- _____ 58. I find it easy to obey God and be available for His use.
- _____ 59. I feel at ease in sharing Christ with nonbelievers.
- _____ 60. I feel that I should share the gospel with people who are different.

Spiritual Gifts Survey

- 5 – Highly characteristic of me/definitely true for me
4 – Most of the time this would describe me/be true for me
3 – Frequently characteristic of me/true for me about 50% of the time
2 – Occasionally characteristic of me/true for me about 25% of the time
1 – Not at all characteristic of me/definitely untrue for me

- _____ 61. I have an acute awareness of the physical needs of others.
- _____ 62. I possess an unusual capacity to understand the feelings of those in distress.
- _____ 63. I have a strong sense of stewardship based on the recognition that God owns all things.
- _____ 64. I like to meet visitors at church and make them feel welcome.
- _____ 65. I can influence others to perform to their highest God-given potential.
- _____ 66. I am skilled in setting forth positive and precise steps of action.
- _____ 67. I can give a clear, uncomplicated presentation.
- _____ 68. I have a wide range of study resources and know how to secure information.
- _____ 69. I have been able to apply biblical truth to the specific needs of people.
- _____ 70. God gives me messages to deliver to His people.
- _____ 71. I am able to sense whether people are being honest when they tell of their religious experiences.
- _____ 72. God has used me to encourage others to live Christ-like lives.
- _____ 73. I have sensed the need to help other people become more effective in their ministries.
- _____ 74. I feel assured that a situation will change for the glory of God, even when the situation seems impossible.
- _____ 75. I like to talk about Jesus to those who do not know Him.
- _____ 76. I enjoy presenting the gospel to persons of other cultures and backgrounds.
- _____ 77. I enjoy doing little things that help people.
- _____ 78. I recognize the signs of stress and distress in others.
- _____ 79. I desire to give generously and unpretentiously to worthwhile projects and ministries.
- _____ 80. I am comfortable meeting new people.

Spiritual Gifts Survey

Scoring

Follow these directions to figure your score for each spiritual gift.

1. Place your numerical response (1-5) to the questions for each item number listed below the box.
2. For each gift, add the numbers in the boxes and put the total in the TOTAL box on the right side.

LEADERSHIP		+		+		+		+		=	
	Item 1		Item 17		Item 33		Item 49		Item 65		TOTAL
ADMINISTRATION		+		+		+		+		=	
	Item 2		Item 18		Item 34		Item 50		Item 66		TOTAL
TEACHING		+		+		+		+		=	
	Item 3		Item 19		Item 35		Item 51		Item 67		TOTAL
KNOWLEDGE		+		+		+		+		=	
	Item 4		Item 20		Item 36		Item 52		Item 68		TOTAL
WISDOM		+		+		+		+		=	
	Item 5		Item 21		Item 37		Item 53		Item 69		TOTAL
PROPHECY		+		+		+		+		=	
	Item 6		Item 22		Item 38		Item 54		Item 70		TOTAL
DISCERNMENT		+		+		+		+		=	
	Item 7		Item 23		Item 39		Item 55		Item 71		TOTAL
EXHORTATION		+		+		+		+		=	
	Item 8		Item 24		Item 40		Item 56		Item 72		TOTAL
SHEPHERDING		+		+		+		+		=	
	Item 9		Item 25		Item 41		Item 57		Item 73		TOTAL
FAITH		+		+		+		+		=	
	Item 10		Item 26		Item 42		Item 58		Item 74		TOTAL
EVANGELISM		+		+		+		+		=	
	Item 11		Item 27		Item 43		Item 59		Item 75		TOTAL
APOSTLESHIP		+		+		+		+		=	
	Item 12		Item 28		Item 44		Item 60		Item 76		TOTAL
SERVICE/HELPER		+		+		+		+		=	
	Item 13		Item 29		Item 45		Item 61		Item 77		TOTAL
MERCY		+		+		+		+		=	
	Item 14		Item 30		Item 46		Item 62		Item 78		TOTAL
GIVING		+		+		+		+		=	
	Item 15		Item 31		Item 47		Item 63		Item 79		TOTAL
HOSPITALITY		+		+		+		+		=	
	Item 16		Item 32		Item 48		Item 64		Item 80		TOTAL

Spiritual Gifts Listed in the Bible

1. **LEADERSHIP** – Romans 12:6, 8 – This gift is used by God for the purpose of discovering and casting the “big picture” vision. Individuals with this gift are able to convey vision to the body of Christ and to inspire believers to use their gifts to accomplish the mission. **Key words – vision, lead.**
2. **ADMINISTRATION** – 1 Corinthians 12:28 – Persons with the gift of administration are typically detailed organizers and strategic thinkers with the ability to take a big picture vision and break it down into stages of development and orderly tasks. They are good at delegating tasks and monitoring their progress. **Key words – strategy, organize.**
3. **TEACHING** – Romans 12:6-7 – This gift is given to serve and strengthen the body of Christ by teaching sound doctrine in relevant ways and empowering people to gain a sound and mature spiritual education. It is their passion to make biblical concepts clear and understandable and they seek opportunities to help others grasp biblical truth. **Key words – teach, train.**
4. **KNOWLEDGE** – 1 Corinthians 12:7-8 – The gift of knowledge usually manifests itself from learning and teaching. It is the God-given desire and ability to learn, to know, and to explain the precious truths of God’s Word. They are drawn to extensive study of God’s Word and the historical context in which it was written. **Key words – scholar, knowledgeable.**
5. **WISDOM** – 1 Corinthians 12:7-8 – Wisdom is the gift that discerns the work of the Holy Spirit. Individuals with this gift are often sought after by members of the body who need counsel and sound advice. They have the ability to offer practical ways to apply biblical truth in real-world situations. They recognize God as the primary source of wisdom and direction. **Key words – wise, direction.**
6. **PROPHECY** – Ephesians 4:7, 11 – The gift of prophecy is proclaiming the Word of God boldly. This builds up the body and leads to conviction of sin. Prophecy usually manifests itself in preaching and teaching. It includes both “forth telling” (preaching) and “foretelling” (revelation). They frequently receive and share specific direction from God for comforting, challenging, and confronting His people. **Key words – confrontation, boldness.**
7. **DISCERNMENT** – 1 Corinthians 12:7-10 – Discernment aids the body by recognizing peoples’ true intentions. Discernment tests the message and actions of others for the protection and well-being of the body. They are able to “read” others and are most often correct in their assessment. They can recognize the spiritual source of a message. **Key words – discerning, authenticity.**
8. **EXHORTATION** – Romans 12:6, 8 – Possessors of this gift help others live God-centered lives through inspiration, encouragement, counseling, and empowerment. This gift is also known as “encouragement”. Individuals with this gift are able to help believers trust in the sovereignty of God in difficult times. They see the circumstances of life from a spiritual rather than a physical perspective. They look to the eternal rather than the temporal. **Key words – encourage, inspire.**

Spiritual Gifts Listed in the Bible

9. **SHEPHERDING** – Ephesians 4:7, 11 – The gift of shepherding is manifested in persons who look out for the spiritual welfare of others. Although pastors, like shepherds, do care for members of the church, this gift is not limited to a pastor or staff member. Individuals having this gift have the ability to develop personal, trust-based relationships with a small number of people. **Key words – guide, mentor.**
10. **FAITH** – 1 Corinthians 12:7, 9 – Faith trusts God to work beyond the human capabilities of people. Believers with this gift encourage others to trust God in the face of apparently insurmountable odds. They typically have a passionate prayer life and embrace ideas that most see as impossible. **Key words – believe, trust.**
11. **EVANGELISM** – Ephesians 4:7-11 – Those with the gift of evangelism lead others to Christ effectively and enthusiastically. They have a deep concern for those who do not know Christ. They are good at building relational bridges with non-believers and seem to have a sense when a person is open to Christ’s message of forgiveness. **Key words – witness, outreach.**
12. **APOSTLESHIP** – Ephesians 4:7, 11 – Apostles motivate the body to look beyond its walls in order to carry out the Great Commission. Apostleship provides people with the desire and ability to start new endeavors for God, most often churches. They are eager to be known as ambassadors for Christ in the world. **Key words – motivator, entrepreneur.**
13. **SERVICE/HELPER** – 1 Corinthians 12:28 – Those with the gift of service/helping recognize practical needs in the body and joyfully give assistance to meeting those needs. Those exercising this gift typically take on the challenges of ministry that occur “behind the scenes” and do not seek recognition for their service. They have a servant heart and are fulfilled in serving others. **Key words – assisting, servant.**
14. **MERCY** – Romans 12:6, 8 – Persons with this gift aid the body by empathizing with hurting members. They keep the body healthy and unified by keeping others aware of the needs within the church. This gift is seen in Christians that are drawn to minister to the needs of those in hospitals, nursing homes, prisons, etc. They are able to connect at a deep level with those who are grieving and walk with them through difficult seasons of life. **Key words – care, empathize.**
15. **GIVING** – Romans 12:6, 8 – Members with the gift of giving give freely and joyfully to the work and mission of the body beyond the tithe. Cheerfulness and liberality are characteristics of individuals with this gift. They prefer their donations to be anonymous and recognize that their resources are merely tools for God’s use. **Key words – generosity, abundance.**
16. **HOSPITALITY** – 1 Peter 4:9-10 – Those with this gift have the ability to make visitors, guests and strangers feel at ease. Persons with this gift integrate new members into the body and are known for making those around them feel valued and significant. They desire that people always feel loved and welcomed and often have gatherings at their home for fellowship. **Key words – welcome, valued.**

How Do I Discover My Spiritual Gift(s)?

1. It will be initiated by prayer – Set a goal before God.

“And we pray this in order that you may live a life worthy of the Lord and may please him in every way: bearing fruit in every good work, growing in the knowledge of God.” – Colossians 1:10

2. It will be enlightened by study – Learn about the gifts.

*“Now about spiritual gifts, brothers, I do not want you to be ignorant.”
– 1 Corinthians 12:1*

3. It will be indicated by desire – Consider your inclinations.

*“Delight yourself in the Lord and he will give you the desires of your heart.” –
Psalm 37:4*

4. It will be activated by involvement – Go to work.

“I remind you to fan into flame the gift of God. . . For God did not give us a spirit of timidity, but a spirit of power, of love and of self-discipline.” – 2 Timothy 1:6-7

5. It will be confirmed by ability – Listen to the evaluations of Christian friends.

*“But to each one is given the manifestation of the Spirit for the common good.”
– 1 Corinthians 12:7 (NASB)*

6. It will be accompanied by blessing – Look at the results.

*“This is to my Father’s glory, that you bear much fruit, showing yourselves to be my disciples.”
– John 15:8*

7. It will be maximized by surrender – Give yourself to God.

*“Therefore, I urge you, brothers, in view of God’s mercy, to offer your bodies as living sacrifices, holy and pleasing to God—this is your spiritual act of worship.”
– Romans 12:1*

Avoid Spiritual Gift Traps!!

Trap #1 – Comparison -- Never let your spiritual gift be a source of pride or inferiority.

“I give each of you this warning: Don’t think you are better than you really are. Be honest in your evaluation of yourselves, measuring yourselves by the faith God has given us. Just as our bodies have many parts and each part has a special function, so it is with Christ’s body. We are many parts of one body, and we all belong to each other.” – Romans 12:3-6

Trap #2 – Projection -- Never expect others to excel to the same degree in the area of your own spiritual giftedness.

*“There are different kinds of gifts, but the same Spirit. There are different kinds of ministries, but the same Lord. There are different kinds of working, but the same God works all of them in all men.”
– 1 Corinthians 12:4-6*

Trap #3 – Rejection -- Do not refuse to accept and use your spiritual gift to serve others.

“Do not neglect your gift.” – 1 Timothy 4:14

“Each one should use whatever gift he has received to serve others, faithfully administering God’s grace in its various forms.” – 1 Peter 4:10

Trap #4 – Concentration -- Do not limit your service exclusively to the area of your spiritual gift and neglect other responsibilities you have for others.

All Christians are commanded to: Teach (Col. 3:16); Serve (Gal. 5:13);

Encourage (Heb.10:25); Give (Luke 6:38); Show mercy (Col. 3:12)

Trap #5 – Substitution -- Never substitute the use of your spiritual gift for genuine love for others.

“If I speak in the tongues of angels, but have not love, I am only a resounding gong or a clanging cymbal. If I have the gift of prophecy & can fathom all mysteries & all knowledge, & if I have a faith that can move mountains, but have not love, I am nothing. If I give all I possess to the poor & surrender my body to the flames, but have not love, I gain nothing.” – 1 Corinthians 13:1-3

What a Spiritual Gift is not:

1. A spiritual gift is not the fruit of the Spirit.

Fruit of the Spirit	Spiritual Gifts
"Being" Qualities	"Doing" Qualities
Attitudes	Aptitudes
By-product of healthy walk with God	Supernatural abilities given by the Spirit
Necessary for effective ministry	Necessary for effective ministry
Examples: Love, Joy, Peace, Self-Control	Examples: Faith, Evangelism, Discernment

2. A spiritual gift is not a church office or ministry position.

Church Offices / Ministry Positions	Spiritual Gifts
General roles	Specific functions
"Title" of positions	"Tasks" to perform
Organizational positions	Ministry contributions
Examples: Elder, Deacon, Senior Pastor	Examples: Shepherding, Helps, Giving

3. A spiritual gift is not a natural talent.

Natural Talents	Spiritual Gifts
Given at physical birth	Given a spiritual birth
God-given to all people	God-given to all believers
Vary in degree and kind	Vary in degree and kind
Manager ⇒ into ⇒ Leadership/Administration Salesperson ⇒ into ⇒ Evangelism	

"Many books get the discovery process backwards. They say, 'Discover your spiritual gift and then you'll know what ministry you're supposed to have.' It actually works the exact opposite way. Just start serving; experimenting with different ministries, and then you'll discover your gifts. Until you're actually involved in serving, you're not going to know what you're good at."
– Rick Warren, The Purpose Driven Life

"Don't look for God to fill in all the blanks. Don't wait for Him to remove all the uncertainty. Realize He may actually increase the uncertainty and leverage all the odds against you, just so you will know in the end that it wasn't your gifts but His power through your gifts that fulfilled His purpose in your life."– Erwin McManus, Seizing Your Divine Moment

Spiritual Gifts

HEART

Abilities

Personal Behavior

Experiences



1. What is meant by “heart”?

“Heart” is a God-given, deep-seated emotional attachment to a particular area of human need or ministry that compels us to make a difference.

“For God is working in you, giving you the desire and the power to do what pleases him.” – Philippians 2:13 (NLT)

“Never be lacking in passion, but keep your spiritual intensity, serving the Lord with all your heart.” – Romans 12:11

2. How does God use my “heart” for His glory?

“Heart” is the means by which God moves and motivates you with emotional energy.

“Then the family heads of Judah and Benjamin, and the priests and Levites—everyone whose heart God had moved—prepared to go up and build the house of the Lord in Jerusalem.” – Ezra 1:5

God uses a burning desire, an intense feeling, a deep-seated concern, a gut-wrenching attachment, a heart-felt connection, or a passionate mission.

3. Why does God use my “heart” for His purposes?

“Heart” is the way that God directs and draws you to the focus of your ministry.

“I went to Jerusalem, and after staying there three days I set out during the night with a few men. I had not told anyone what my God had put in my heart to do for Jerusalem.” – Nehemiah 2:11-12

“It has always been my ambition to preach the gospel where Christ was not known, so that I would not be building on someone else's foundation.” – Romans 15:20

God may direct your “Heart” to ...Right a wrong...Meet a need...Solve a problem...Serve a cause...Change a life

“Listening to Your Heart”

A Ministry Passion Assessment

Description:

The purpose of this assessment is to assist you in the identification and articulation of your God-given Ministry Passion. The results will release greater motivation and enthusiasm in your life and ministry.

Directions:

1. You may not be able to answer all of the questions. That is OK. The assessment is designed to explore a variety of ways God speaks to our Heart about our Ministry Passion. He has probably spoken to you in some of these ways, but not all of them.
2. Prayerfully consider your responses to each question.
3. Since this is an individual exercise, complete the Assessment on your own. (You can talk about it with others afterwards).
4. There are no right or wrong answers. You have permission to say what is truly in *your* heart.
5. At this point, do not consider *whether* you could do it or *how* you could do it. All you need to do right now is ***name*** it.
6. Assume there are no obstacles to hinder you from fulfilling your heart’s desire or ministry passion. Assume everything is taken care of – family, money, career, time, etc.

Questions:

- 1. What Moves You?** If you could snap your fingers and know that you could not fail, what would you do for others? What do you really want to do for God? What moves your heart to take action?

2. **What Needs Grip You?** What do you repeatedly see that annoys or angers you that if changed, would be more glorifying to God and uplifting to others? What unmet needs in the lives of other can keep you up at night?

3. **Who Do You Care About?** Who do you feel you can most profoundly influence for God? What age range do you feel drawn to? What affinity group does your heart go out to?

Some Possible People Groups: (It is OK if you do not have a desire to make a difference in these areas).

- | | | |
|--|--|---|
| ☐ Infants | ☐ Children | ☐ Youth |
| ☐ Teen moms | ☐ Single parents | ☐ College students |
| ☐ Divorced | ☐ Widowed | ☐ Singles |
| ☐ Career women | ☐ Young marrieds | ☐ Refugees |
| ☐ Parents | ☐ Empty nesters | ☐ Homeless |
| ☐ Unemployed | ☐ Elderly | ☐ Disabled |
| ☐ Prisoners | ☐ Poor | ☐ Hospitalized |
| ☐ Professionals | ☐ Migrant workers | ☐ Children of divorce |
| ☐ Ethnic group | ☐ Alcoholics / Addicts | ☐ International students |
| ☐ Unchurched | ☐ Cults / Other religions | ☐ Street gang members |
| ☐ Military people | | |
| ☐ Other: _____ | | |

4. **What Cause Will You Help Champion?** What cause makes your heart race? What social issue tugs at your heart? What is it in our society that really bugs you? (See list on following page.)

Some Possible Social Issues or Causes: (It is OK if you do not have a desire to make a difference in these areas).

- | | | |
|---|--|--|
| ☐ Environment | ☐ Abuse / Violence | ☐ Alcoholism |
| ☐ At-risk children | ☐ Parenting | ☐ Homosexuality |
| ☐ Discipleship | ☐ HIV / AIDS | ☐ Health care |
| ☐ Politics | ☐ Law / Justice system | ☐ Racism |
| ☐ Educational issues | ☐ Homelessness | ☐ Compulsive behavior |
| ☐ Marriage / Family | ☐ Divorce | ☐ Disabilities |
| ☐ Poverty / Hunger | ☐ Drug abuse / recovery | ☐ Sanctity of life |
| ☐ Literacy | ☐ Nutrition | ☐ Child care |
| ☐ Immigration issues | ☐ Peacekeeping | ☐ Financial stewardship |
| ☐ Abortion | ☐ Civil rights | ☐ Prayer |
| ☐ Other: _____ | | |

5. What Dream Will You Fulfill? What have you dreamed about doing or imagined yourself becoming involved in? What secret ambition have you wanted to pursue but were afraid to tell anyone about? When you are alone, do you ever wonder, "What if...?" Does your response to that question create emotional energy? What is it?

6. For What Would You Like to Be Remembered? At the end of your life, you would love to be able to look back and know you had done something about

Conclusions: Reviewing your responses to the above questions, how might you summarize your heartfelt passion in a phrase or a sentence? I have a passion for (to):

Which *one* of the following Ministry Passion Categories best reflects your area of passion? Where do have a heart for ministry?

Check Here	Passion Category	Description
	Celebration Ministries	<i>The heart of these ministries is directed toward God by engaging the church in the Word, worship, song, the arts, etc.</i>
	Outreach Ministries	<i>The heart of these ministries is focused on relating, reaching, and connecting unbelievers and the unchurched to a relationship with Christ and his church.</i>
	Connecting Ministries	<i>The heart of these ministries is assimilating visitors, attenders, and members into a relationship with Christ and the church through hospitality, fellowship, belonging, and encouragement.</i>
	Equipping Ministries	<i>The heart of these ministries is maturing believers in the area of their gifts, ministry, training and leadership. It serves a variety of life-stage and affinity-based groups for growth, accountability, and service.</i>
	Caring Ministries	<i>The heart of these ministries is assisting people in the church and in the community with their physical, emotional, relational, and spiritual health through the grace, love, and resources of the kingdom.</i>
	Supporting Ministries	<i>The heart of these ministries is freeing other people, leaders, and ministries from practical concerns to keep focused on their ministry goals. They involve structuring the systems and procedures to serve and support people and ministries.</i>



Spiritual Gifts

Heart

ABILITIES

Personal Behavior

Experiences

1. What is meant by natural abilities?

A natural ability is a special talent or skill that God distributes to his children at birth or develops in them through life's circumstances for the benefit of others.

"Then Moses summoned Bezalel and Oholiab and every skilled person to whom the LORD had given ability and who was willing to come and do the work." – Exodus 36:2

"What do you have that you did not receive [from God]?" – 1 Corinthians 4:7b

2. Why does God give us special abilities, skills and talents?

Possessing natural abilities produces spiritual responsibilities.

What I'm able to do, God wants me to do.

*"To one he gave five talents of money, to another two talents, and to another one talent, **each according to his ability**. Then he went on his journey." – Matthew 25:15*

3. How does God want us to use our natural abilities?

Every ability, no matter how great or how insignificant, can be used for the glory of God and the good of others.

"Another of his disciples, Andrew, Simon Peter's brother, spoke up, 'Here is a boy with five small barley loaves and two small fish, but how far will they go among so many?' Jesus said, 'Have the people sit down.' There was plenty of grass in that place, and the men sat down, about five thousand of them. Jesus then took the loaves, gave thanks, and distributed to those who were seated as much as they wanted. He did the same with the fish. When they had all had enough to eat, he said to his disciples, 'Gather the pieces that are left over. Let nothing be wasted.' So they gathered them and filled twelve baskets with the pieces of the five barley loaves left over by those who had eaten.'" – John 6:8-13

"So whether you eat or drink or whatever you do, do it all for the glory of God." – 1 Corinthians 10:31

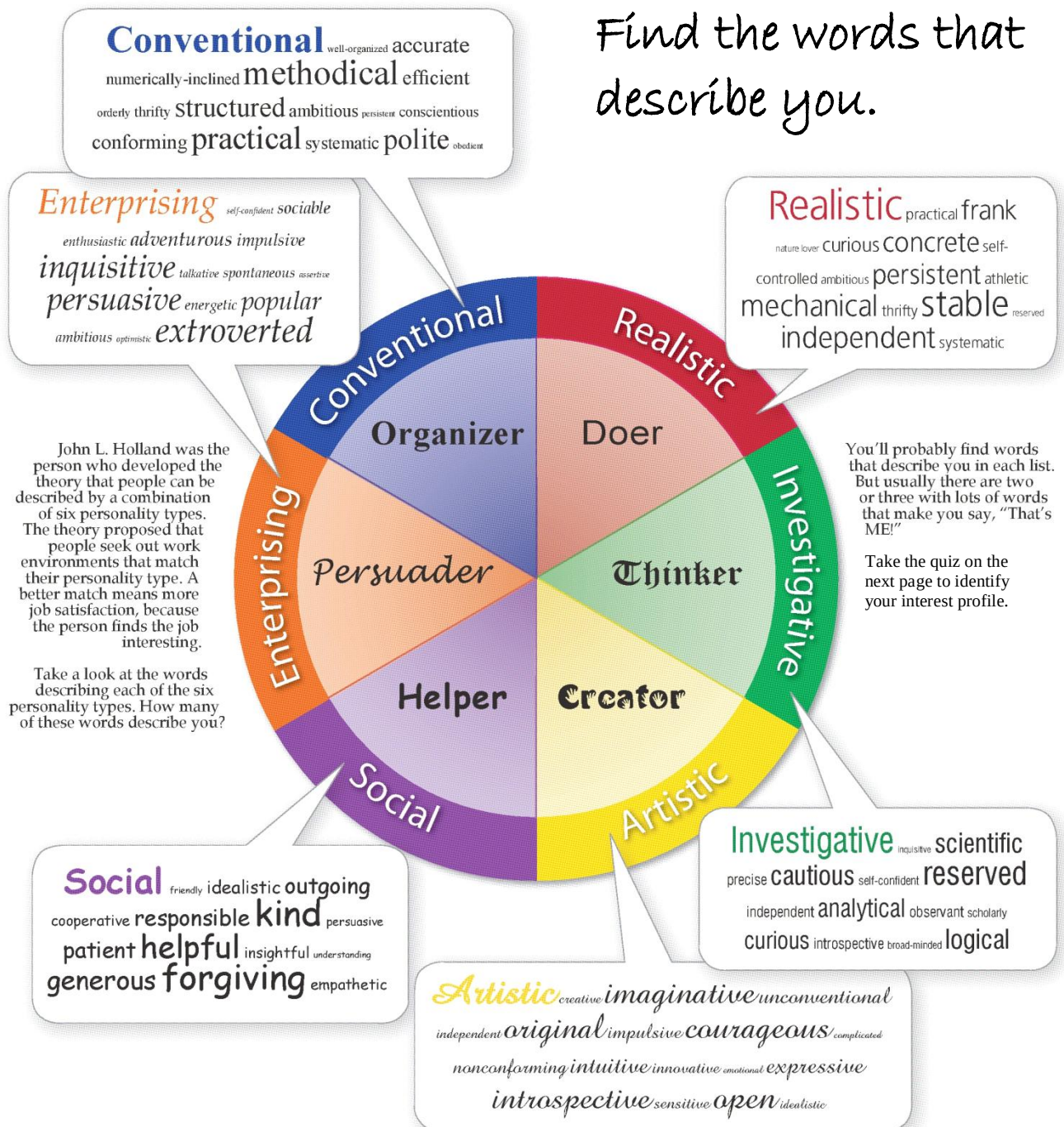
1. What things do you do well naturally, that you have a natural aptitude for, things that come very easily for you? (For example, organizing, building things, creating, relating to others, repairing things, problem solving, etc.)

2. What things are you able to do well because of special training, education, or practice? (For example, computer skills, musical instruments, drama, singing, planning special events, leadership training, carpentry, electrical, plumbing, etc.)

3. What things in the lists above do you also really enjoy doing and receive a sense of fulfillment in doing?

Holland Codes

Find the words that describe you.



Based on the Holland Code by Dr. John L. Holland

This assessment is based on Dr. John Holland's theory that people and work environments can be loosely classified into six different groups. Different peoples' personalities may find different environments more to their liking. While you may have some interests in and similarities to several of the six groups, you may be attracted primarily to two or three of the areas. These two or three letters are your Holland Code.

For example, with a code of RES you would most resemble the *Realistic* type, somewhat but less resemble the *Enterprising* type, and somewhat but even less resemble the *Social* type. The types that are not in your code are the types you resemble least of all. Most people, and most jobs, are some combination of two or three of the Holland interest areas.

Read each statement below and, if you agree with it, put a checkmark in the box to the right of it.

Do you like to ...

... do puzzles?	☐	... put things together or assemble models?	☐
... work on cars?	☐	... be creative?	☐
... attend concerts, theaters or art exhibits?	☐	... pay attention to details?	☐
... work in teams?	☐	... do filing or typing?	☐
... organize things like files, offices or activities?	☐	... learn about other cultures?	☐
... set goals for yourself?	☐	... analyze things like problems, situations or trends?	☐
... build things?	☐	... play instruments or sing?	☐
... read fiction, poetry or plays?	☐	... dream about starting your own business?	☐
... have clear instructions to follow?	☐	... cook?	☐
... influence or persuade people?	☐	... act in plays?	☐
... do experiments?	☐	... think things through before making decisions?	☐
... teach or train people?	☐	... work with numbers or charts?	☐
... help people solve their problems?	☐	... discuss issues like politics or current events?	☐
... take care of animals?	☐	... keep records of your work?	☐
... have your day structured?	☐	... be a leader?	☐
... sell things?	☐	... work outdoors?	☐
... do creative writing?	☐	... work in an office?	☐
... work on science projects?	☐	... work on math problems?	☐
... take on new responsibilities?	☐	... help people?	☐
... heal people?	☐	... draw?	☐
... figure out how things work?	☐	... give speeches?	☐

Total up your checkmarks by color and record the number in the colored boxes . . . the three letters with the highest scores are your **Interest Profile**.

Realistic	Investigative	Artistic	Social	Enterprising	Conventional

Three highest scores = Your Interest Profile		

Based on the Holland Code by Dr. John L. Holland, Source: www.mincareers.org



Spiritual Gifts

Heart

Abilities

PERSONAL BEHAVIORAL STYLE

Experiences

1. What is my personal behavioral style?

Personal style consists of your unique, God-given behavioral characteristics which indicate the way you normally prefer to relate to people and respond to the world around you. It is your behavioral DNA or simply the way God has individually “wired” you.

“You made all the delicate, inner parts of my body and knit me together in my mother’s womb. Thank you for making me so wonderfully complex! Your workmanship is marvelous—how well I know it. You watched me as I was being formed in utter seclusion, as I was woven together in the dark of the womb.” – Psalm 139:13-15 (NLT)

“For we are God’s workmanship, created in Christ Jesus to do good works, which God prepared in advance for us to do.” – Ephesians 2:8-10 (NIV)

2. Are some behavioral styles better for ministry than others?

There are no “right” or “wrong” behavioral styles for ministry, but some may “fit” a particular ministry better than others. When you are required to minister in a manner that is ‘out of character’ for your behavioral style, it creates tension, requires extra effort & energy, & produces less than the best results.

“Each of us did the work the Lord gave us. I planted the seed in your hearts, and Apollos watered it, but it was God who made it grow...The one who plants and the one who waters work together with the same purpose. And both will be rewarded for their own hard work. For we are both God’s workers.” 1 Corinthians 3:5b-6, 8-9a (NLT)

3. What is the relationship between my personal style and ministry?

Your personal style will affect how you use your spiritual gifts and abilities.

4. If God made me this way, how am I responsible for bad behavior?

While your personal style can explain your behavior, it does not excuse it!

“Pay careful attention to your own work, for then you will get the satisfaction of a job well done, and you won’t need to compare yourself to anyone else. For we are each responsible for our own conduct.” – Galatians 6:4-5 (NLT)

Behavior Style Assessment

Please assign a number 1, 2, 3, or 4 to each word in **EACH ROW ACROSS** the page.
 Number 4 is most like you *really* are, and Number 1 is least like you *really* are (**NOT** how you would like to be someday or how you hope people see you).
 You must choose **one** 1, 2, 3, and 4, in **EACH of the 20 ROWS** of words across the page.
EACH of the 20 ROWS across the page should equal 10.

1. ___ Confident	___ Enthusiastic	___ Calm	___ Accurate	= 10
2. ___ Problem Solver	___ Fun-loving	___ Accommodating	___ Reserved	= 10
3. ___ Self-reliant	___ Creative	___ Cautious Humor	___ Discerning	= 10
4. ___ Likes Having Authority	___ Group-oriented	___ Even-tempered	___ Analytical	= 10
5. ___ Bold	___ Initiator	___ Patient	___ Conscientious	= 10
6. ___ Action-minded	___ Enjoys Change	___ Good Listener	___ Predictable	= 10
7. ___ Strong-willed	___ Visionary	___ Peacemaker	___ Practical	= 10
8. ___ Goal-driven	___ Risk-taker	___ Sensitive	___ Under Control	= 10
9. ___ Competitive	___ Motivator	___ Loyal	___ Scheduled	= 10
10. ___ Controlling	___ Outgoing	___ Non-demanding	___ Systematic	= 10
11. ___ Decisive	___ Tells Good Stories	___ Enjoys Stability	___ Courteous	= 10
12. ___ Forceful	___ Friendly	___ Steady	___ Careful	= 10
13. ___ Results-oriented	___ Optimistic	___ Supportive	___ Perfectionist	= 10
14. ___ Takes Charge	___ Talks a Lot	___ Thoughtful	___ Orderly	= 10
15. ___ Independent	___ Enjoys Life	___ Tolerant	___ Persistent	= 10
16. ___ Opinionated	___ Energetic	___ Relational	___ Inquisitive	= 10
17. ___ Causes Change	___ Likes Variety	___ Sympathetic	___ Detailed	= 10
18. ___ Impatient	___ Spontaneous	___ Easygoing	___ Consistent	= 10
19. ___ Accepts Challenges	___ Inspirational	___ Warm	___ Quality Focus	= 10
20. ___ Not Easily Discouraged	___ Impulsive	___ Avoids Confrontations	___ Serious-minded	= 10
				= 200

TEAMWORK

All Behavior Styles Working Together as a Team

	<i>Description of My Behaviors</i>	<i>To Be a Better Team Member I Need</i>
Dominance	I am action-oriented. I make quick decisions. I can solve difficult problems. I am forceful and strong-willed. I lead others to get the job done. I am very competitive. I can take the heat.	Direct answers, bottom-line information. Wide range of responsibilities. Authority to function. Freedom from controls and restrictions. Challenges and changes. To be surrounded by "people" persons. To pace myself and relax more.
Influence	I am energetic and full of life. I love fun and laughter. I am creative and innovative. I can inspire and motivate others. I love to express my thoughts. I want to work with others, not alone. I am spontaneous and impulsive.	Public recognition of ability. Freedom of expression. Freedom from control and details. Opportunities to talk. Enthusiastic, fun atmosphere. Coaching from "task" persons. To be accountable for responsibilities.
Steadiness	I am warm and relational. I am a good follower and team player. I do not like negative people. I try to avoid conflict. I love to serve others. I am a good listener. I am supportive and encouraging.	Stable, secure environment. Sincere appreciation. Group identification. Minimal conflict. Standard procedures. Help in accepting changes. Encouragement to grow.
Conscientiousness	I want things done right. I am accurate and consistent. I seek to do excellent work. I am not outgoing most of the time. I love weighing pros and cons. I want a systematic approach. I need time to make decisions.	Businesslike atmosphere. Answers to questions. Controlled environment. Opportunities to use special skills. Performance expectations. Feedback on performance. Encouragement to be flexible.

THE PERCEPTION BARRIER

We tend to view other team members in terms of their negatives, not their positives, especially those with different behavior styles from ours.

Type	Positive Characteristics	Possible Negatives
D	Decisive Independent Efficient Practical Determined	Harsh Pushy Dominating Severe Tough
I	Stimulating Enthusiastic Dramatic Outgoing Personable	Excitable Egotistical Reactive Manipulative Talkative
S	Supportive Willing Dependable Reliable Agreeable	Conforming Too Nice Dependent Slow Retiring
C	Thorough Persistent Orderly Serious Industrious	Critical Stuffy Indecisive Moralistic Picky

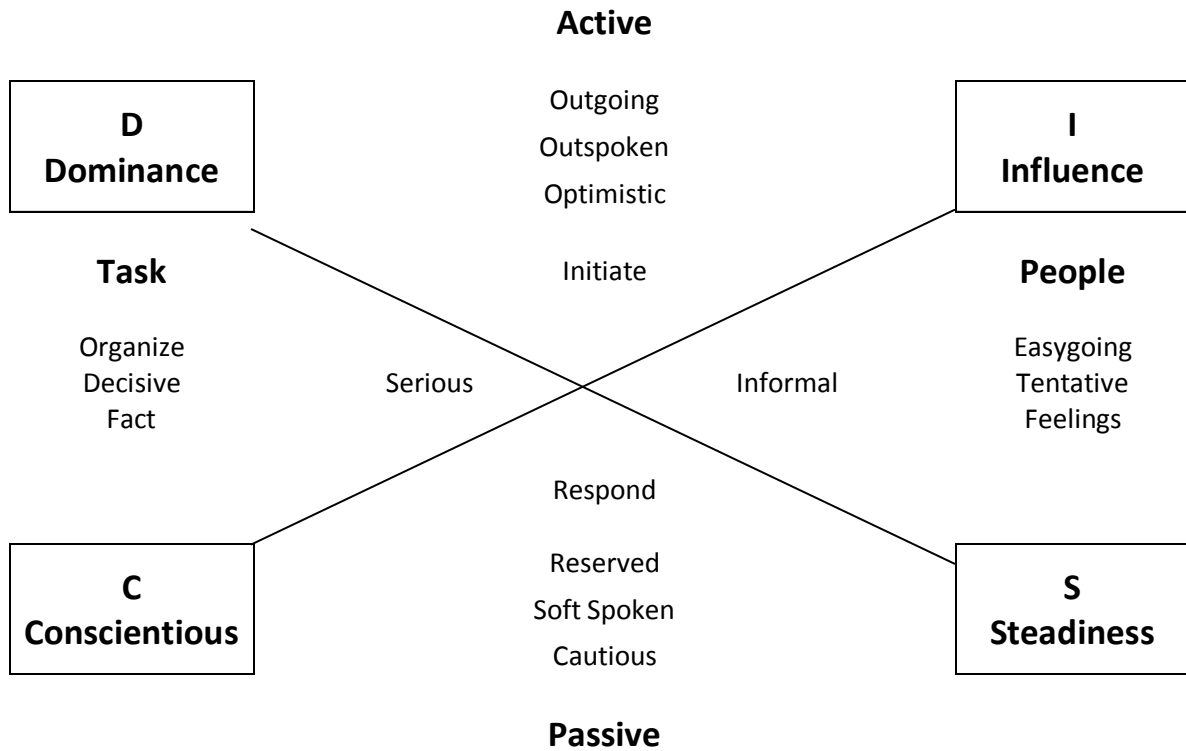
How to overcome the perception barrier and build commitment to team members:

1. View them in terms of their positive, not their negative characteristics.
2. Become a champion of their positive contributions.
3. Be available to complement their negative side with your positive side.
4. Ask them to complement your negative side with their positive side.

UNDERSTANDING YOUR TEAM'S COMBINED STYLE

	D	I	S	C
Value to the Team	Takes initiative	Influences people	Builds relationships	Focuses on details
Major Positive Characteristics	Strength of purpose; goal oriented; gets things done	Enthusiasm; gets people motivated, involved	Good people skills; good team player and concern for feelings of others	Thoroughness; accuracy in analyzing all the data
Major Negative Characteristics	Can be insensitive to feelings of others; impatient	Impulsiveness; may not focus attention on detail/facts	May sacrifice results for harmony; reluctant to initiate	Overly cautious; can be too thorough and lose sight of time
Motivated By	Results; challenge; action	Recognition; approval; visibility	Relationships; appreciation; inclusion	Being Right; quality; validation
Time Management	Focus: Now; efficient use of time; likes to get to the point	Focus: Future; tends to rush to the next exciting thing	Focus: Present; spends time in personal interaction, sometimes to the detriment of the task	Focus: Past; works more slowly to ensure accuracy
Communication	One-way – often not a good listener; better at initiating communication	Enthusiastic; stimulating; often one-way; can inspire others	Two-way flow; a good listener - especially in relation to feelings	Good listener; especially in relation to facts and processes
Emotional Response	Detached; independent	High and Low; excitable	Warm; friendly	Sensitive; careful
Decision Making	Intentional; always makes decisions with goal in mind	Intuitive; quick; lots of wins and losses	Relational; makes decisions more slowly with input from others	Reluctant; thorough; needs lots of evidence and time
Behavior Under Stress	<i>Autocratic</i>	<i>Attacking</i>	<i>Acquiescing</i>	<i>Avoiding</i>
Would Improve Effectiveness By	<i>Listening</i>	Slowing Down	Initiating	Being Flexible

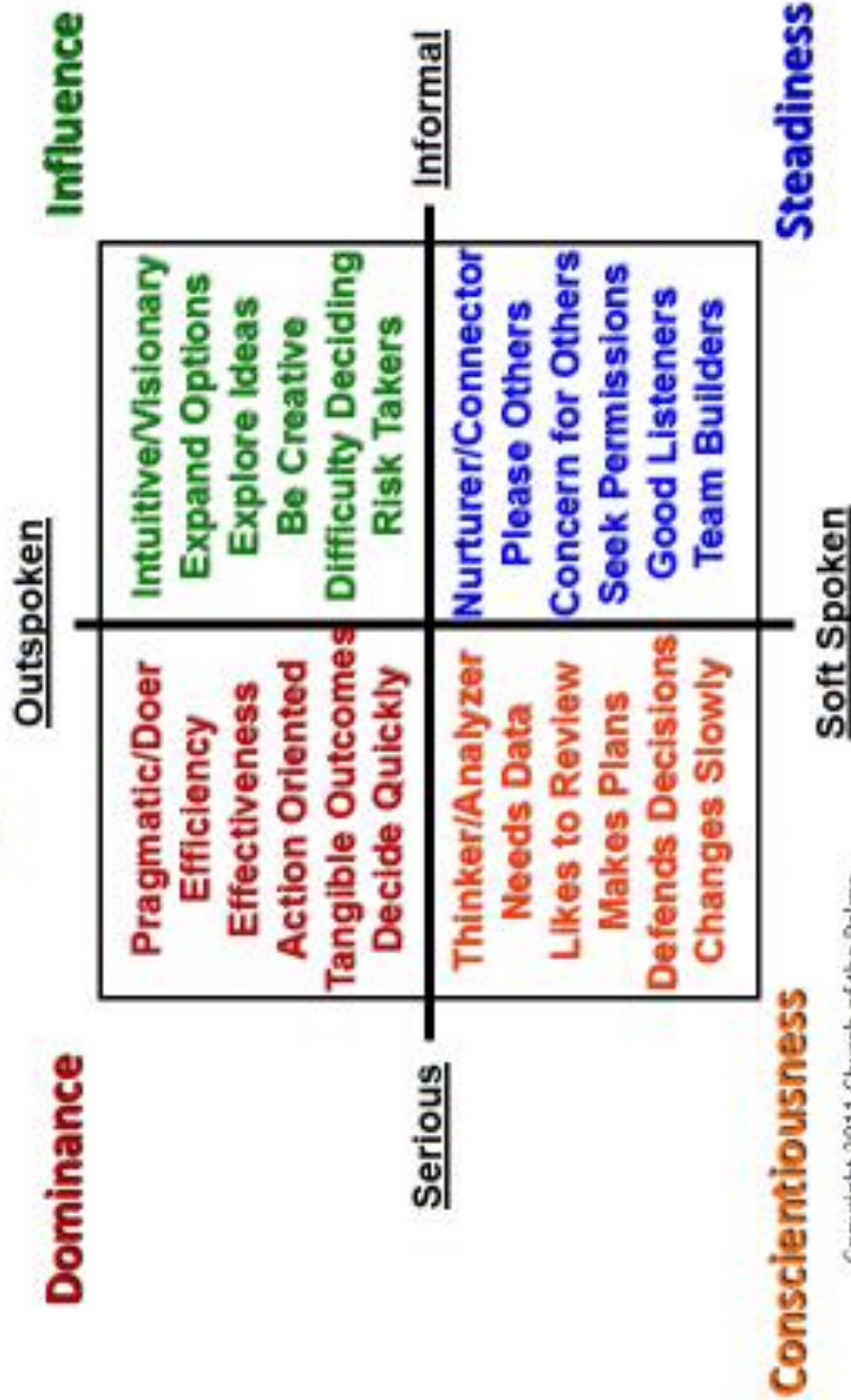
BEHAVIOR STYLE: BLENDS (Vertical and Horizontal) And OPPOSITES (Diagonals)



1. DISC (Dominance, Influence, Steadiness, Conscientiousness)
Inscape Publishing, Inc. Minneapolis, Minnesota
2. Hippocrates' Four Temperaments (Choleric, Sanguine, Phlegmatic, Melancholy)
Spirit-Controlled Temperament
By Tim LaHaye, Tyndale House Publishers
3. Animal Characters (Lion, Otter, Retriever, Beaver)
Make Love Last Forever
By Gary Smalley, Lifeway Press
4. The Personality Compass (North, South, East, West)
By Turner and Greco, Barnes and Noble

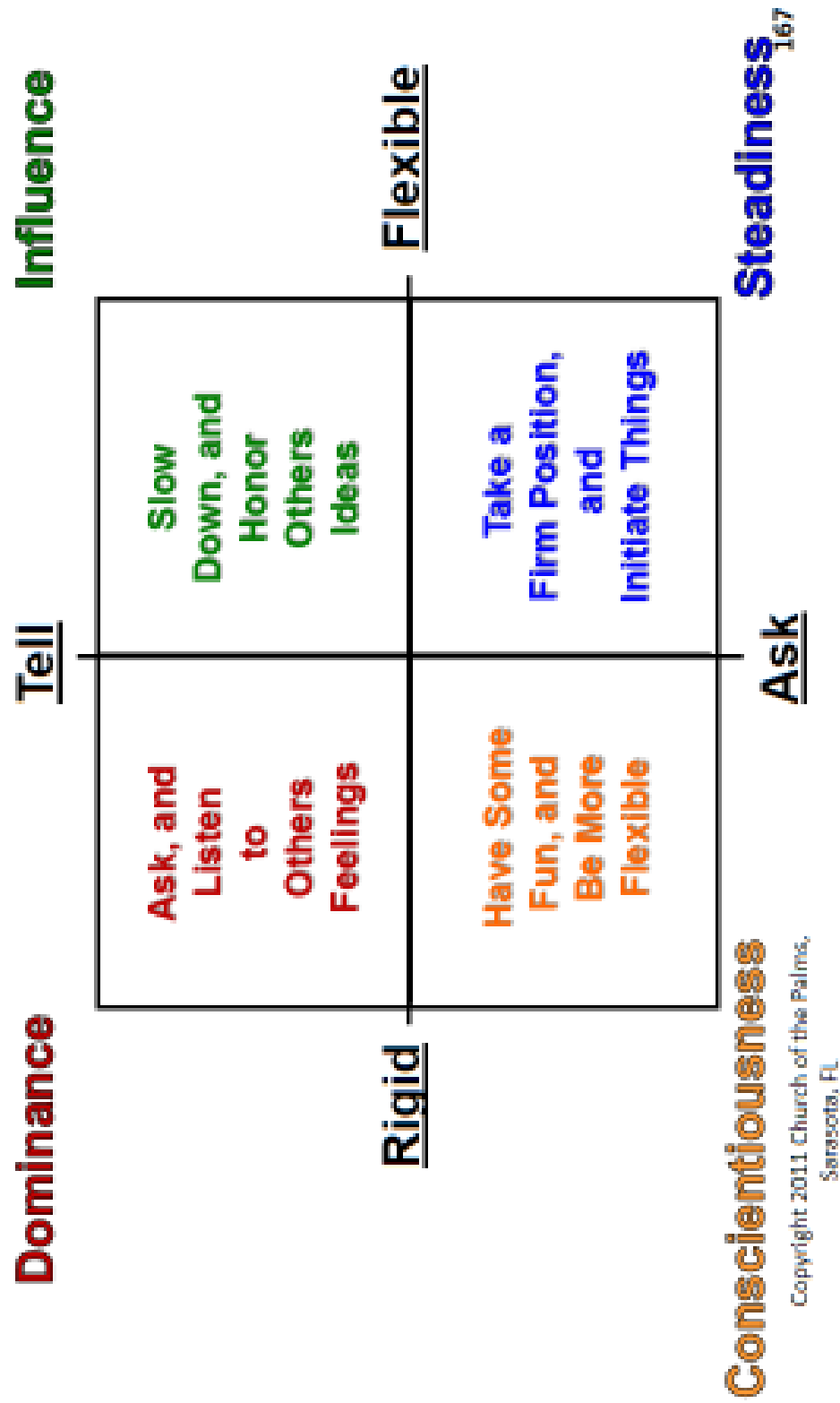
Four Quadrants

Key Attributes



Copyright 2011 Church of the Palms,
Sarasota, FL

To Improve Your Effectiveness



“C” Behavior-Style Versatility for COP S.H.A.P.E.

- Develop a strong personal friendship with a same-gender “I” Style person.
- Loosen up.
- Get past the trees and see the whole forest.
- Give more enthusiastic support for innovative ideas.
- Look for how to help things succeed rather than why they will fail.
- Be less verbally critical of others.
- Don’t get stuck in “analysis paralysis.”
- Put some FUN in your life every day.
- Resist the temptation to publicly criticize others, even when they deserve it.
- Remember that what you call USEFUL DEBATE, many others call PETTY ARGUING.
- Allow people the reality of human imperfection.
- Let yourself look kind of grubby occasionally.
- Realize that minute details can seem to others to be boring and unimportant.
- Learn to ask for help without feeling that you are incompetent.
- Try something different from time to time.
- Express how you feel, not just what you think.
- Let your guard down occasionally.
- Don’t worry so much. Be more action oriented.
- Become more flexible. To you it may seem wishy-washy; to others, just adaptable.
- Learn to get through the day without the words “No!” and “Why?”
- Accept that many of the new ways of doing things are actually better.
- Develop a strategy for keeping from getting bogged down in your own thoughts.
- Resist turning up your nose at everything that is not the very finest.
- Learn to develop more realistic expectations of both yourself and others.
- Forgive yourself, honestly and thoroughly, for not being perfect.
- Help others not to feel inferior.
- Fight against the tendency to develop tunnel vision.
- Practice wearing an authentic, warm smile.
- Develop a sense of humor.
- Don’t take yourself so seriously.
- Practice seeing things from the perspectives of others.
- Do some things out of your normal sequence occasionally.
- Give yourself permission to be outrageously creative.
- Get off “square one.”
- Take more risk than your comfort zone would indicate.
- Learn to relax around other people.
- Try some new things without thinking about failing or finishing.
- Rebel against the status quo.
- Explore new ideas and methodologies.
- Learn to exude some enthusiasm.
- Develop more of a free spirit.

“D” Behavior-Style Versatility for COP S.H.A.P.E.

- Develop a strong personal friendship with a same-gender “S” Style person.
- Help people more often.
- Go out of your way to be friendly.
- Listen to others attentively.
- Pay attention to the personal and business needs of others.
- Do not dominate in every interaction with others.
- Ask for others’ ideas, opinions, and feedback – and use them.
- Share power by truly delegating authority.
- Develop value for processes, not just for bottom-line results.
- Cooperate!
- Think about ways you can help someone, and do it.
- Brainstorm for ideas before charging ahead.
- Don’t shout when you feel angry.
- Occasionally put people needs above accomplishing tasks.
- Be less judgmental of others.
- Become more humble.
- Say, “I apologize!” and mean it.
- Learn to enjoy the game, not just the victory.
- Count to 10 when inclined to brag or show off.
- Take a back seat for awhile and relax.
- Take a break!
- Hold on tightly to your tongue when you want to take over a situation.
- Don’t rush everything, and learn to value others who take their time.
- Make an extra effort not to hurt people’s feelings.
- Don’t sweat the small stuff.
- Make time for personal conversations and relationships.
- Be more open-minded to the views of others.
- Manage your behavior to prevent standing up or arguing.
- Give credit where credit is due. And it’s probably due more than you think!
- Enjoy people, not just the task.
- Control your natural impatience.
- Become sensitive to the effects of your behavior on others.
- Say, “Thank you!” and mean it.
- Practice random acts of kindness that no one knows about but you.
- Smile warmly while you look people in the eye.
- Take time to socialize and chat with people.
- Ask, “How are you?” and listen actively to the response.
- Avoid looking at your watch while others are talking.
- Avoid walking around the room while you are talking.
- Stay off the subject of yourself, and focus on others.
- Ask more questions, gently – and listen carefully to the answers.

“I” Behavior-Style Versatility for COP S.H.A.P.E.

- Develop a strong personal friendship with a same-gender “C” Style person.
- Get more focused.
- Get more organized.
- Finish what you start.
- Pay more attention to details.
- Check and recheck your work.
- Be on time.
- Be more cautious – less willing to take risks.
- Just tell it like it is – resist the temptation to exaggerate.
- Get below the surface with others – be more authentic about yourself.
- Resist your tendency to be impulsive.
- Strive for accuracy and precision.
- Dig more into the details.
- Take full responsibility for a task/project. Be accountable.
- Use processes and procedures. Resist your inclination to “wing-it.”
- Pay close attention when others are speaking.
- Become more predictable. Walk your talk.
- Do what is needed, even when it is boring to you.
- When you “rock the boat” be sure to focus on attacking the problem, not the people.
- Be more conservative in the way you dress.
- Pay more attention to and follow the required processes and procedures.
- Slow down.
- Explain your logic to others.
- Give people some warning when you change the topic of conversation.
- Let others have more “air time.”
- Pay more attention what others think and how they want to do things.
- Practice sitting still.
- Work on extending your attention span.
- Make firm, clear commitments and keep them.
- Finish some of your old tasks before starting new ones.
- Don’t insist on reinventing the wheel every time you take on a new piece of work.
- Listen when people “nag” and “nit-pick.” They are trying to tell you something.
- Practice objectivity – stop trying to put the right “spin” on the truth.
- Don’t push your luck.
- Resist the temptation to create chaos and confusion just for fun.
- Keep up with your things.
- Be sensitive to others reaction to your sense of humor.
- Make a list of TO DO’s and USE IT!
- Avoid bizarre and weird extremes.
- Analyze the Pro’s and Con’s of ideas.
- Ready, Aim, Fire; NOT Fire, Ready, Aim!

“S” Behavior-Style Versatility for COP S.H.A.P.E.

- Develop a strong personal friendship with a same-gender “D” Style person.
- Practice being more TELL assertive.
- Take charge of a situation without being asked.
- Speed Up: Walking, Talking.
- Focus energy more on the task, less on relationships.
- Express your opinions more, especially when you think yours are different.
- Make decisions quickly, and announce them clearly to affected parties.
- Make a special effort to meet deadlines – no excuses.
- Stay on the task, especially when tempted to go and talk with someone.
- Take the initiative.
- Don’t put off the difficult or controversial tasks.
- Become more independent and self-sufficient.
- Learn to enjoy some “alone” time.
- Speak out in meetings. Take a position, and let others know what it is.
- Avoid the tendency to engage in long or frequent chat sessions.
- Practice making and holding direct eye contact.
- Shake hands firmly.
- Practice competing with yourself and others to exceed past successes.
- Seek out leadership roles and fulfill them with high energy.
- Learn to fight fairly for what you believe in.
- Speak more confidently, loudly, and forcefully.
- Avoid personalizing and being overly sensitive.
- Help yourself as much as you help others.
- Develop more trust in your abilities.
- Get quickly to the point.
- Be willing to disagree and able to explain your logic.
- Ask for help when you need it.
- Avoid becoming overly friendly or ingratiating.
- Don’t try so hard to please others. Go for what you want and believe in.
- Make only the promises you are sure you will keep.
- Do it NOW – don’t procrastinate.
- Avoid the tendency to get into the “victim” or the “martyr” roles.
- Complete tasks that need to be done – don’t leave so many loose ends.
- Learn some conflict resolution strategies and implement them.
- Learn and practice time management techniques to be more productive.
- Use the impatience of others to remind you to speed up.
- Learn and practice stress management practices.
- Learn to say NO, and mean it.
- Make sure you get your share of recognition for a job well done.
- Practice getting out of your comfort zone and experiment with new behaviors.
- Become more demanding of others – less willing to wait, less accommodating.

DISC Worksheet for S.H.A.P.E. - People's Names and Descriptors

TELL: _____, _____, _____, _____

D = DOMINANCE STYLE	I = INFLUENCE STYLE
C = CONSCIENTIOUSNESS STYLE	S = STEADINESS STYLE

TASK: _____

PEOPLE: _____

ASK: _____, _____, _____, _____

18 Questions to Determine Another Person's Behavior Style

- For Relationship Improvement -

(Circle the appropriate letter in each of the 18 questions. Count the total number of B's, A's, L's, and R's, and write that total in each box next to its letter.)

Compared to people with whom you interact the most, their behavior style:

1. Seems more focused on getting TASKS done (L) or more on other's FEELINGS (R)?
2. ASKS more questions (B) or makes more TELL statements (A)?
3. Has a time schedule that seems more FLEXIBLE (R) or more RIGID (L)
4. Tends to COMPETE more (A) or COOPERATE more (B)?
5. Has a more CONTROLLED (L) or a more EXPRESSIVE (R) face?
6. Prefers to RESPOND to others (B) or prefers to INITIATE personal interactions (A)?
7. Exhibits thinking that seem more INTUITIVE (R) or more LOGICAL (L)?
8. Moves/Talks more RAPIDLY (A) or more DELIBERATELY (B)?
9. Seems to decide based more on FACTS (L) or based more on FEELINGS (R)?
10. Is more likely to DO WHAT IS "RIGHT" (B) or to TAKE MORE RISK (A)?
11. Acts more FRIENDLY (R) or more RESERVED (L)?
12. Speaks more LOUDLY (A) or more SOFTLY (B)?
13. Appears to be more SERIOUS (L) or more PLAYFUL (R)?
14. Takes a position more CAUTIOUSLY (B) or more FORCEFULLY (A)?
15. Appears more APPROACHABLE (R), or more FORMAL (L)?
16. Likes to stay with the BIG PICTURE (A), or likes to get into the DETAILS (B)?
17. Uses FEWER HAND/ARM GESTURES (L), or use MORE HAND/ARM GESTURES (R)?
18. Has LESS DIRECT eye contact (B), or has MORE DIRECT eye contact (A)?

B

A

(B + A should = 9)

High A and High L = D

High A and High R = I

R

L

(R + L should = 9)

High B and High R = S

High B and High L = C

Spiritual Gifts
Heart
Abilities
Personal Behavior
Experiences



1. What is God's perspective on my past experiences?

God has shaped your past with purpose.

"And we know that God causes all things to work together for good to those who love God, to those who are called according to His purpose... [to be] conformed to the likeness of his Son."
– Romans 8:28 (NASB)

"You intended to harm me, but God intended it all for good. He brought me to this position so I could save the lives of many people." – Genesis 50:20 (Joseph to his brothers)

God uses our past experiences to equip us for ministry.

"Praise be to the God and Father of our Lord Jesus Christ, the Father of compassion and the God of all comfort, who comforts us in all our troubles, so that we can comfort those in any trouble with the comfort we ourselves have received from God." – 2 Corinthians 1:3-4

God wants us to review and reflect upon our past experiences for spiritual insight and direction

"Jesus replied, 'You do not realize now what I am doing, but later you will understand.'"
– John 13:7

5. What past experiences can God use for His glory?

Positive Experiences and Achievements

Painful Experiences and Low Points

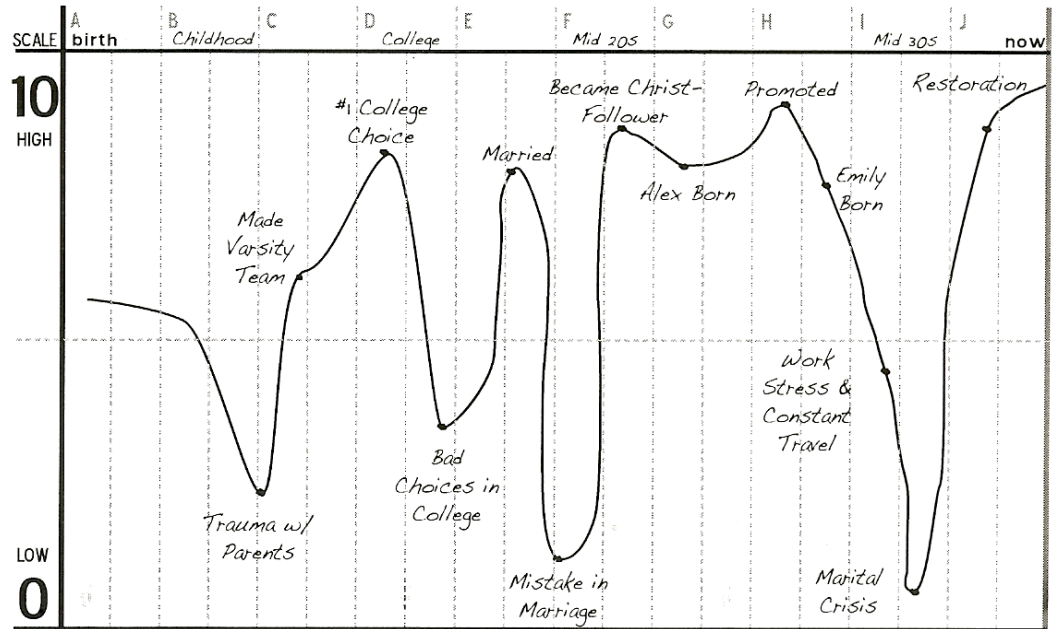
1. *Personal (Positive or Painful)*
2. *Vocational (Positive or Painful)*
3. *Relational (Positive or Painful)*
4. *Educational (Positive or Painful)*
5. *Spiritual (Positive or Painful)*

To help you pinpoint the significant past experiences of your life, you'll find two timelines to the right. The top timeline is a sample and the bottom one is for your use. After reading these instructions, reflect on your life and begin filling out your timeline.

Instructions:

1. Use another sheet of paper to make a list of 15-20 significant events and important circumstances from your life (include both positive and painful experiences).
2. Go to the timeline and label the divisions on the top of the timeline with your years of life (e.g., age 5, age 25, etc.) or life-stages (e.g., college, early marriage, etc.)
3. Using the vertical scale of 0-10 and the horizontal scale of your life, place a dot for each of the major events of your life. "0" represents the lowest, painful events, and "10" represents the highest, positive events. Place a dot to represent each event, when it happened on the time-line, and how high or low the event was in your experience. (You may want to use a pencil).
4. Connect the dots with a line.
5. Now reflect upon your life and transfer the results to the positive or painful experiences assessment.

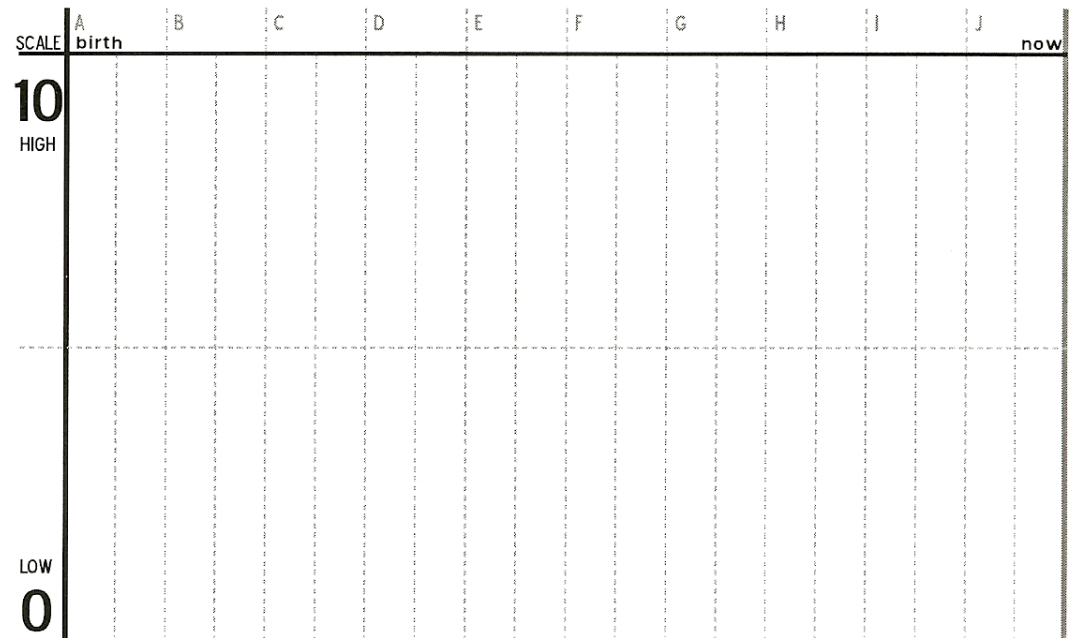
SAMPLE TIMELINE



LEARNING

I longed for connection with my parents, but they were lost in their own troubles. I felt valuable when I was achieving in sports, academics, or work. When I am over-achieving I often neglect important relationships. When I feel like I am under-achieving I'm tempted to escape into unhealthy behaviors. My best moments have been about relationships (--with God, new friends, etc)

PERSONAL TIMELINE



LEARNING

Examining Your Past Experiences

Significant Personal Achievements:

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

Significant Vocational Achievements:

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

Significant Relational Achievements:

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

Significant Educational Achievements:

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

Significant Spiritual Achievements:

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

Significant Personal Low Points:

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

Significant Vocational Low Points:

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

Significant Relational Low Points:

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

Significant Educational Low Points:

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

Significant Spiritual Low Points:

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

"Life can only be understood backwards, but it must be lived forwards."
– Soren Kierkegaard

How to Maximize Your Past Experiences for God's Glory

1. Give God your will [central control for personal actions & thoughts]

"I desire to do your will, O my God; your law is within my heart." -- Psalm 40:8

"Do not let any part of your body become an instrument of evil to serve sin. Instead, give yourselves completely to God, for you were dead, but now you have new life. So use your whole body as an instrument to do what is right for the glory of God." – Romans 6:13

2. Give God your worries [mentally dwelling on life's uncontrollables].

"Humble yourselves, therefore, under God's mighty hand, that he may lift you up in due time, casting all your anxiety on him because he cares for you." – 1 Peter 5:6-7

"Do not be anxious about anything, but in everything, by prayer and petition, with thanksgiving, present your requests to God. And the peace of God, which transcends all understanding, will guard your hearts and your minds in Christ Jesus." – Philippians 4:6-7

3. Give God your wounds [physical, social, or emotional hurts].

"He heals the brokenhearted and binds up their wounds." – Psalm 147:3

4. Give God your wrongs [known sins of omission or commission].

"Therefore, since we are surrounded by such a huge crowd of witnesses to the life of faith, let us strip off every weight that slows us down, especially the sin that so easily hinders our progress. And let us run with endurance the race that God has set before us. We do this by keeping our eyes on Jesus, to whom our faith depends from start to finish." – Hebrews 12:1-2 (NLT)

"If we confess our sins, he is faithful and just and will forgive us our sins and purify us from all unrighteousness. If we claim we have not sinned, we make him out to be a liar and his word has no place in our lives." – 1 John 1:9-10

5. Give God your weaknesses [natural limitations we cannot change].

"So to keep me from becoming proud, I was given a thorn in my flesh, a messenger from Satan to torment me and keep me from becoming proud. Three times I pleaded with the Lord to take it [the thorn] away from me. But he said to me, 'My grace is sufficient for you, for my power is made perfect in weakness.' Therefore I will boast all the more gladly about my weaknesses, so that Christ's power may rest on me. That is why, for Christ's sake, I delight in weaknesses...For when I am weak, then I am strong" – 2 Corinthians 12:7-10

"The Spirit helps us in our weakness... because the Spirit intercedes for the saints in accordance with God's will." – Romans 8:26-27

My Personal S.H.A.P.E. Profile

Name: _____ Date: _____

Address: _____ City: _____ State: ____ Zip: _____

Home Phone: _____ Work Phone: _____

E-Mail: _____ Cell Phone: _____

Spiritual Gifts: What I am gifted to do:

1. _____ 2. _____ 3. _____

→ Check appropriate boxes on page 47, "Spiritual Gifts".

Heart: What I have a passion for.

At this time, I would say that my ministry passion is to (or for):

And I think that the category that best reflects my heart's desire for ministry is:

- | | | |
|---|--|--|
| ☐ Celebration Ministries | ☐ Connecting Ministries | ☐ Equipping Ministries |
| ☐ Outreach Ministries | ☐ Caring Ministries | ☐ Supporting Ministries |

Abilities: What I naturally excel at.

I feel that my top natural abilities & special skills I can use to glorify God are:

1. _____ 2. _____ 3. _____

Personal Behavioral Style: How God has wired me.

My personal style is: ☐ Dominance ☐ Influence ☐ Steadiness ☐ Conscientious

My behavioral tendency is to be: ☐ Task-Oriented ☐ People-Oriented

☐ Structured ☐ Unstructured

Experiences: Where I have been.

Positive experiences from my past which I feel could help others include:

Painful experiences from my past which I feel could help others include:

→ Check appropriate boxes on page 47, "Skills and Experience Inventory".

As a disciple of Christ, I will be more focused, fruitful, fulfilled, and faithful
when I use my *Spiritual gifts* and *natural Abilities*
in the area of my *Heart's desire* and *past Experiences*
in a way that best expresses my *Personal behavioral style*.

Time Availability: My schedule or stage in life that may affect my service.

Check Here	Time Availability	Description
	Unavailable	Cannot serve at this time as my time schedule or stage in life will not allow it.
	Limited	1 - 2 hours per week
	Moderate	2 - 4 hours per week
	Expanding	4 or more hours per week

→ Check appropriate box on page 47, "Availability".

Spiritual Maturity: My maturity level should match my ministry.

Check Here	Spiritual Maturity	Description
	Seeker/Unsure	I am not sure how to describe my current level of spiritual maturity and wonder if I even have a personal relationship with Jesus.
	New/Young Believer	I have just recently become a Christian and am just beginning my journey with Jesus.
	Stable/Growing Follower	I am regular in worship, fellowship, giving, and pursuing a life of greater devotion to Christ. I am sensitive to the leading of the Spirit in my life.
	Modeling/Mature Christian	I am a fully devoted follower of Jesus. I have reached a level in my walk with God that others look to me as an example of faithfulness.

→ Check appropriate box on page 47, "Spiritual Maturity".

Some of My Ministry Possibilities:

1. _____ 2. _____
3. _____ 4. _____

→ Check appropriate boxes on page 48, "Areas of Interest"

Church of the Palms – SERVANT PROFILE

NAME _____ DATE _____

ADDRESS _____
 Street City State Zip Code

EMAIL _____

PHONE (Home) _____ (Work) _____ (Cell) _____

OCCUPATION (former, if retired) _____

VOLUNTEER EXPERIENCE _____

LEADERSHIP POSITIONS HELD _____

WHICH SERVICE DO YOU USUALLY ATTEND? ☐ 9:00 Traditional ☐ 9:00 Modern ☐ 11:00 Traditional

AGE GROUP ☐ Under 18 ☐ 18-35 ☐ 36-45 ☐ 46-50 ☐ 51-60 ☐ 61-70 ☐ 71-80 ☐ 81+

Gifts, Abilities and Experience Summary

AVAILABILITY

- ☐ Limited 1-2 hours per week
- ☐ Moderate 2-4 hours per week
- ☐ 4 or more hours per week
- ☐ M-F
- ☐ Saturday
- ☐ Sunday
- ☐ AM
- ☐ PM
- ☐ Evenings

SPIRITUAL GIFTS

- ☐ Leadership
- ☐ Administration
- ☐ Teaching
- ☐ Knowledge
- ☐ Wisdom
- ☐ Prophecy
- ☐ Discernment
- ☐ Exhortation
- ☐ Shepherding
- ☐ Faith
- ☐ Evangelism
- ☐ Apostleship
- ☐ Service/Helper
- ☐ Mercy
- ☐ Giving
- ☐ Hospitality

SPIRITUAL MATURITY

- ☐ Seeker/Unsure: *Not sure how to describe my level of spiritual maturity, not sure if I have a relationship with Jesus.*
- ☐ New/Young Believer: *Just recently became a Christian, just beginning my journey.*
- ☐ Stable/Growing Believer: *Regular in worship, giving, serving and growing.*
- ☐ Modeling/Mature Believer: *Fully devoted follower and example to others.*

SKILLS & EXPERIENCE INVENTORY

Administrative

- ☐ Customer Service
- ☐ Event Registration
- ☐ Multi-Button Telephones
- ☐ Filing/Organization
- ☐ Copier Machines
- ☐ Writing Grant Proposals
- ☐ Library & Media Management

Computer

- ☐ MS Word
- ☐ MS Excel
- ☐ MS Publisher
- ☐ MS Power Point
- ☐ Data Entry
- ☐ Database Mgmt
- ☐ Reporting Systems
- ☐ SQL

Finance

- ☐ Bookkeeping
- ☐ Budgeting
- ☐ Financial Planning
- ☐ Auditing
- ☐ Spreadsheets
- ☐ Stewardship
- ☐ Fundraising
- ☐ Planned Giving

Language Skills

- ☐ Spanish
- ☐ French

Communications

- ☐ Marketing
- ☐ Displays
- ☐ Public Relations
- ☐ Photography
- ☐ Graphic Arts
- ☐ Desktop Publishing
- ☐ Video Production/Editing
- ☐ Web Design/Update
- ☐ Social Media

Facilities

- ☐ Set-Up/Tear Down
- ☐ Heavy Lifting
- ☐ Design/Decorating
- ☐ Painting
- ☐ Handyman
- ☐ Electrical
- ☐ Plumbing
- ☐ Carpentry
- ☐ Landscape/Gardening

Music & Arts

- ☐ Vocals
- ☐ Musical Instrument

- ☐ Drama
- ☐ Dance
- ☐ TV Camera
- ☐ Sound Board

Leadership

- ☐ Classroom Leadership
- ☐ Small Group Leadership
- ☐ Ministry Team Leadership
- ☐ Outreach Leadership
- ☐ Event Planning
- ☐ Legal Consulting

Ministry Experience

- ☐ Deacon
- ☐ Elder
- ☐ Children's Ministry
- ☐ Student Ministry
- ☐ Stephen Ministry
- ☐ Counseling
- ☐ Outreach
- ☐ Coaching/Mentoring
- ☐ Pastor
- ☐ Special Needs

Professional

- ☐ Doctor
- ☐ Nurse
- ☐ Education
- ☐ Tutoring
- ☐ Driver – CDL License

Other

- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____

Areas of Interest

Please check the items in which you have an interest in participating or in which you would consider serving.

WORSHIP, MUSIC & ARTS

Prayer Ministry

- ☐ Sunday Morning Prayer Group

Hospitality

- ☐ Yellow Umbrella Greeters
- ☐ Sanctuary Greeters __9:00 __11:00
- ☐ Sanctuary Ushers __9:00 __11:00
- ☐ Garden Greeters
- ☐ Welcome Center
- ☐ Coffee Hosts

Traditional Worship (*The Sanctuary*)

- ☐ TV Ministry
- ☐ Flower Committee (Sunday after 11:00 Service)
- ☐ Communion Preparation (Saturday a.m.)
- ☐ Pew Rack Committee
- ☐ Acolytes/Crucifers (7-17 Yrs Old)
- ☐ Christmas Decoration Team

Modern Worship (*The Garden*)

- ☐ Worship Team
- ☐ Media Technician
- ☐ Sound Board Operator
- ☐ Set-Up/Tear Down

Music & Arts

- ☐ Chancel Choir
- ☐ Cantori Choir (Christmas Season Only)
- ☐ Praise and Glory Singers
- ☐ String Class
- ☐ Sounds of Glory Orchestra
- ☐ Jubilee Ringers

FAMILY MINISTRY

Behind the Scenes

- ☐ Event Coordination
- ☐ Communications
- ☐ Administrative
- ☐ Prayer Partner
- ☐ Hospitality Volunteer

Working with Kids/Students

- ☐ Children (Birth to 5th grade)
- ☐ Students (6th to 12th grade)

CONGREGATIONAL CARE

- ☐ Friendly Visitors
- ☐ Memorial Services and Funerals
- ☐ Stephen Ministry
- ☐ Shepherding Deacons

ADULT MINISTRIES

- ☐ PALMS University Class Leader
- ☐ Palms Life Small Group Leader
- ☐ Food/Kitchen Ministry
- ☐ Presbyterian Women
- ☐ Palms Men
- ☐ Time Tithers (Handyman)

OUTREACH MINISTRIES

- ☐ Food Pantry
- ☐ Tutoring
- ☐ Day of Hope
- ☐ Good Samaritan Mission
- ☐ Job Resources
- ☐ "His" Garden
- ☐ Habitat for Humanity
- ☐ Resurrection House
- ☐ Donations
- ☐ Missions Projects

CHURCH ADMINISTRATION

Office/Clerical

- ☐ Receptionist
- ☐ Office/Clerical
- ☐ MS Office Projects
- ☐ Data Entry
- ☐ Filing/Organizing

Facilities

- ☐ Grounds Maintenance
- ☐ Building Maintenance
- ☐ Painting
- ☐ Set-Up/Tear Down

Communications

- ☐ Marketing & PR
- ☐ Photography
- ☐ Proof Reading
- ☐ Layout & Design
- ☐ Printing/Assembling
- ☐ Display Areas
- ☐ Web Design
- ☐ Journalist
- ☐ Researcher
- ☐ Social Media